

SOP-LV-029 — Lone Worker Safety

Minimum Safeguards for Technicians Working Without a Crew

SOP NUMBER	SOP-LV-029
TITLE	Lone Worker Safety
EFFECTIVE DATE	July 25, 2026
REVISION	1.0
APPLIES TO	All Apex field technicians — Ontario & Manitoba
CATEGORY	Personal Safety & Conduct

1. Purpose

This procedure establishes minimum safeguards for Apex technicians dispatched alone to a jobsite without a crew or direct on-site supervision, so that help can reach them quickly if something goes wrong.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to any Apex technician working alone on a jobsite for any part of a shift, regardless of site type. It applies in addition to every other Apex SOP, not instead of them — a lone technician still follows the same fall protection, electrical, and hazard procedures as a crew.

3. Definitions

- Lone Worker — a technician working at a location where no other Apex worker, and no one readily available to assist, is present.
- Check-In Protocol — the agreed schedule and method by which a lone worker confirms their status to a supervisor or dispatch.

4. When Lone Work Is and Is Not Permitted

Most routine low-voltage work can be performed alone. The following always require a second person on site, regardless of schedule pressure:

- Any task requiring fall arrest per SOP-LV-026, where a rescue plan depends on a second person being present.
- Any work near an open, energized electrical panel per SOP-LV-031.
- Any lift beyond one person's safe capacity per SOP-LV-032.
- Any site where a workplace violence risk has already been identified per SOP-LV-028.

5. Check-In Requirements

- Check in with your supervisor or dispatch at the start of the shift, once at midday, and at the end of the shift.
- If a check-in is missed by more than 30 minutes, your supervisor will attempt to contact you directly.

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- If contact cannot be made within 60 minutes of a missed check-in, your supervisor will escalate — contacting the site, your emergency contact, and if warranted, local authorities.

6. Emergency Communication

- Carry a fully charged phone, and a charging cable or backup battery for longer shifts.
- Confirm the exact site address is known and shared with your supervisor before starting work — not just the client name.
- Know how to trigger your phone's emergency SOS feature without looking at the screen.

7. If Injured While Alone

Call 911 first for any serious injury — then call your supervisor.

Do not wait to see if it “gets better” before calling for help. If you cannot reach your phone or speak, your check-in schedule is the backup that ensures someone comes looking.

8. Hostile Encounters While Alone

A hostile or disruptive person is a different risk when you are alone — there is no one to back you up or call for help on your behalf. Follow SOP-LV-028 (Workplace Violence Prevention & De-escalation), and disengage earlier and more readily than you might with a crew present.

9. Prohibited Practices

- Never disable or ignore a company-provided check-in or location-sharing tool, where one is provided.
- Never enter an unfamiliar, unoccupied building alone after hours without confirming access and expected duration with dispatch first.
- Never skip a scheduled check-in because a task is running late — send a quick update instead.

10. Regulatory References

- Ontario Occupational Health and Safety Act, ss. 25–26 — general duty to take every precaution reasonable in the circumstances
- Manitoba Workplace Safety and Health Act, C.C.S.M. c. W210 — general duty provisions

11. Related Apex Documents

- SOP-LV-028 — Workplace Violence Prevention & De-escalation
- SOP-LV-026 — Working at Heights & Fall Protection
- SOP-LV-031 — Electrical Safety — Working Near Energized Equipment

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12. Revision History

Rev.	Date	Description	Approved By
1.0	Jul 25, 2026	Initial release	P. Cimini

This document is proprietary to Apex and is intended for internal use by Apex technicians and supervisors. Effective date: July 25, 2026.